

**T. NAGAR**

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam

Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet

RERA : TN/35/Building/0399/2023  
www.rera.tn.gov.in



## CHENNAI'S HIGHEST ROI HOMES

📍 ECR, Muttukadu

Starts from

**₹1 Cr\***

Rental up to

**14.40%**

**VRX TERRACE ADVANTAGES**



70 Lifestyle  
Amenities



Swim 139 ft  
above sea level



Opp. to  
MGM Dizzee World



Book your site visit

**CREDAI**

**VRX | terrace**



**89257 72223**

\*T&C Apply



LIFFY THOMAS

**K**ey Performance Indicators (KPIs) might have a corporate ring to it, but is universal, touching every human connection, including that of residents of a gated community with their Management Committee (MC). A gated community in Manapakkam has understood this existential truth, hence an “appraisal” of every member of the MC against their self-imposed goals at the beginning of their term. The committee as a whole is assessed against its promises.

Casagrand Irene Owners Welfare Association (CGIOWA) believes it has set a benchmarks through this system. The framework encourages every member to give their best, and those performing well to get re-elected to the committee.

Spread across 5.6 acres with 295 dwelling units across 15 blocks and 13 villas, this gated community in Alandur Zone (Ward 157) of Greater Chennai Corporation is only seven years old.

#### Solar Power Ninja

Association secretary Lebbaeus Denis's KPI was around going solar. With flats ranging from 550 sq. ft. to 3500 sq. ft., the social profile of residents is varied, making buy-in a challenge. After multiple meetings, rooftop solar installation took off in three phases.

“Our 300 KWp rooftop solar project today powers the entire community's common areas including lifts, air conditioners in the club house, water pumps, gym, STP, water treatment plant,



At Casagrand Irene in Manapakkam, every member of the managing committee elected by residents is assessed by key performance indicators established for them

## KPI culture comes home

garden water pumping, street lights, car parking and all common lightings and EV charging stations. TNEB says we are one of the largest in Tamil Nadu's residential segment,” says Denis, who also oversees legal and asset management areas of the community.

Of the ₹1.4 crore invested to implement solar rooftop, CGIOWA took ₹1.25 crore from its corpus and the rest from the revenue streams it generates.

“Our annual electricity bill from the common areas generates over 5.13 lakh unit that translates to ₹ 60 lakh. We have begun to see solar PVC as a significant return on the investment we made,” says the secretary.

Currently, only 25% of rooftop terrace has solar pa-

nels and the rest of the space is available for future expansion of the solar initiative.

Casagrand Irene has brought out a brochure detailing the process and features: how the Association selected M/s Tamilnadu Energy System as vendor; technical specifications of solar panels and inverter; the break-up of electricity charges. With a message from former MLA T.M. Anbarasan, the brochure was distributed to close to 100 communities in the constituency.

#### Mr. Keep It Clean

Early this year, a team from Urbaser Sumeet documented best practices in waste management being adopted by the community. The architect of this system is said to be Karthikeyan M., assisted by his wife, Alagu K. The couple had moved in from Adyar, where they were part of many door-to-door

drives by Residents of Kasturba Nagar (ROKA).

“In my KPI, I had promised to make the community zero waste,” says Karthikeyan, joint secretary overseeing housekeeping operations and waste management. He maintains a tracking mechanism that shows how they collect and monitor waste on a daily and monthly basis.

Over the last six months, for instance, “black plastic cover” used to line garbage bins for wet waste disposal has been reduced from 591 kg to zero kg, thereby preventing plastic waste from going to dumping grounds.

The society also has an organic waste converter and is planning to procure more. “Waste management initiatives at the community are only four years old and we are taking baby steps. We hope to follow the three Rs with the support of residents, housekeeping staff and Urbaser Sumeet,” says Karthikeyan who works with an MNC.

Lebbaeus Denis says CGIOWA functions like a mini-corporate, every process is documented and there is an induction programme before a new committee takes over.

#### The Water Evangelist

For president Senthil Jagadeesan, interest lies in water. He oversees water conservation initiatives including ensuring runoffs go into the 75 recharge pits in the society and grey water is used in garden and for landscape.

Magesh Giri, joint secretary, also shares the ‘department’ with Senthil, overseeing garden and water management.

Ashok Premesh, treasure, is in-charge of revenue management including compliance. Karthikeyan A.S., vice-president, oversees the security and parking management. Likewise, Govarthan, an assistant director in the film industry, was brought into the committee seeing the diversity he would bring to the table. Every Pongal, the society turns into a mini-village under his supervision. Denis says funds is not a constraints for MC members to function effectively. “We go all out to give them what they want and they do perform,” says Denis, a serial entrepreneur. “We have different revenue streams to generate funds. For instance, last year we opened a studio flat with all star facilities. By paying ₹2,000 a day, a resident can use it to accommodate a guest,” he says.

Of the 17 SDG goals, Denis says, the community has ticked seven goals required for community living, and has set its sights on other goals. It is working on getting ISO and LEED certifications.

▼  
An assembly of managing committee members; and a view of the villas.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT





**T. NAGAR**

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam  
Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet

## Good patronage for new park at SVS Nagar

GCC created the facility by removing encroachments



The park in Valasaravakkam.  
PHOTOS: VELANKANNI RAJ B

**L. KANTHIMATHI**

**G**reater Chennai Corporation's park at SVS Nagar First Main Road, off Arcot Road in Valasaravakkam, has emerged as a prominent leisure space in the neighbourhood and witnesses significant footfall every day since its inauguration this March. Called Kalaignar Nootrandu Poonga Matrum Kulam (which translates to Kalaignar Centenary Park-Cum-Pond), the facility spread across 4.05 acres was developed at a cost of ₹4.88 crore, Capital Fund of the Greater Chennai Corporation. The facility features an outdoor gym, an open amphitheatre, a children's play area and a parking lot for two-wheelers. Another interesting feature is an elevated bund resembling an

island that has been created at the pond to attract birds. There is a walkway to access it from the mainland. However, Greater Chennai Corporation has prevented access to it for safety reasons. Further, the staircase leading to the pond has also been fenced. The park is under CCTV surveillance.

Regular visitors to the park appreciate Greater Chennai Corporation for setting up this facility. Valasaravakkam lacked a proper park and therefore we visited the ones in other neighbourhoods such as Ramapuram and K.K. Nagar enduring a drive through congested roads and now we have been spared that trouble, say visitors. Further, this park is much bigger and more beautiful, they add.

"The park has a good number of fitness devices

however given the good patronage, the devices are not enough," says visitor M. Venkatesan. This facility is useful for those who undertake daily walks for the roads are out of bounds for pedestrians, says visitor P. Maheshwari.

The park has another entrance on Ambedkar Road where its presence is made prominent with an arch and is lit with lights. However, this is not the case at SVS Nagar First Main Road entrance as the arch work here remains incomplete and those new to the area can easily miss the park. The park falls within the limits of Ward 151 in Zone 11 - Valasaravakkam.

According to a Greater Chennai Corporation official, this pond was developed as a flood-mitigation measure for SVS Nagar, a low-lying neighbourhood prone to heavy waterlogging during rains.

"GCC learnt from land records that there was a waterbody before and it ceased to exist due to encroachments. GCC reclaimed that area from the encroachers and created the pond and to deter encroachments in the future, a park has been created. Of the 4.05 acre facility, the pond is two acres," says the official.



## FREE WASTE SERVICE FOR BWGS RAISES QUESTIONS

Here are some of the posers. Has this move by Greater Chennai Corporation sounded the death knell of in situ composting? **P3**



## STING OPERATIONS WITH A DIFFERENCE

On World Bee Day, meet three residents of Chennai who have established a bond with bees in very different ways. **P4**

Advertisement

## AUTISM SPECTRUM DISORDER (ASD)

Early onset autism, also known as childhood Autism or Early childhood Autism, is a widespread condition. It is the most common developmental disorder of children. Although it is possible to detect signs at any age, they are most pronounced in the first two years of life.

### Symptoms

- Lack of social interaction.
- Lack of communication and speech.
- There will be stereotype behaviour and interest.
- Less eye contact with others: the child can be adamant.
- Autism is a behavioural syndrome that may cause behavioural and developmental problems.

### Causes

- ★ Genetic Factors: In research on twins, monozygotic twins are more affected than dizygotic twins.
- ★ This confirms that genes also play a major role in autism.
- ★ Perinatal Insult: Any injury to the baby or trauma to the mother's womb - whether the woman is pregnant, giving birth, or after birth-can cause harm. Such injuries during this time can affect the child's brain, resulting in developmental problems and lifelong disabilities.

### Type

- ❖ Autism Spectrum Disorder: They have difficulty communicating socially and have similar repetitive habits. There may be a delay in speech or communication.
- ❖ Autistic Disorder (Classic) : It is usually diagnosed by the age of three and is more common in males than females.
- ❖ Difficulty in social relationships, lack of concentration, and repetitive behaviour.
- ❖ Inability to understand subtle gestures, lack of eye contact, and being adamant.
- ❖ This can lead to excessive attention in certain matters.
- ❖ Asperger's Syndrome : Intelligence and speech skills will be normal or above average.
- ❖ But there will be difficulty with social skills.
- ❖ Difficulty maintaining friendships.
- ❖ Difficulty in understanding the inner meaning of other's social gestures.
- ❖ Difficulty initiating or maintaining a conversation.
- ❖ Difficulty in making friends.
- ❖ Pervasive developmental Disorder : These children have autism-related symptoms, but they are no very severe or not clear, but very subtle.

❖ Rett syndrome: this is a genetic defect that mostly affects girls. Purposeful hand use will gradually reduce.

### Homoeopathic Approach

1. There are two types of autism: By Birth and After Birth. Majorly, it's because of physical trauma or emotional trauma affecting the gestational period.
2. Our Right side Brain deals with imagination and feelings.
3. The left Brain deals with logic and understanding.
4. The Right Brain controls the left side of the body, and the Left Brain controls the right side of the body.
5. In a human baby, the first organ to grow normally is the brain. This helps to understand feelings, socialization, fear, good, bad, safety, etc.
6. But, in autistic children, the right brain does not work well from the beginning.
7. That's why they can't understand feelings well and are unable to understand others in our society.
8. However, the Left brain works more, so they can play fast, do math, and logical things.
9. Homoeopathy helps in many ways through medicine, and it can change the behavioural problems, hyperactivity, and sensory processing in a better way. Homoeopathy can treat this in a better way because it treats the patient as an individual. The medicine is selected on the basis of individualization.
10. The birthplace of homoeopathy in Indian is Thanjavur. We are practicing here since 30 years and are treating the patients. We also have clinics in Chennai and Trichy. We are conducting a free medical camp for autistic children every second Sunday of a month.
11. Our clinic is named **PRANAVAA HOLISTIC HOMEO CLINIC & RESEARCH CENTRE**. It is located near the new bus stand, Thanjavur RR-Nagar, Reliance apartment near central bus stand, Trichy and in coral spring apartment, RR colony Jafferhanpet, Ashok Nagar, Chennai and we are doing our services.



📍 Thanjavur  
98424 33473

📍 Thanjavur RR nagar  
99655 33473

📍 Trichy  
95973 33473

📍 Chennai  
97910 55500

✉ e-mail : drilangoshc@gmail.com



## Chaos at junction in Mettupalayam



The junction at Govindan Road. PHOTOS: UMESH KUMAR. V

**S.N. RAJARM**

The junction of Govindan Road and Andiappan Street (also known as Kavarai Street) and Kodambakkam Road at Mettupalayam in West Saidapet needs better traffic regulation. It is only rarely that this intersection is regulated by traffic police.

A traffic signal stood at this

junction until a few years ago; it was removed for reasons unknown to us. Pedestrians trying to cross the junction are in peril. One witnesses a huge number of motorcyclists and pillion riders without helmets at this junction. Appropriate safety measures such as speed breakers are needed here.

*S.N. Rajaram is a resident of Saligramam*



## ‘Bharanthiputhur Service Road in a battered state’

**R.K. RAVICHANDRAN**

Kovur-Bharanthiputhur Service Road which is along Perungalathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass is marked by potholes. The battered road is a result of stormwater drain work carried out 15 years ago and after completion of the work the road has not been relaid to this day. This gives room for waterlogging during rains.

This road provides connectivity to Porur-Kundrathur Main Road, Mugaliwakkam-Mangadu Road, Bharanthiputhur -Iyyappanthangal Road and therefore witnesses good traffic.

Besides, a good number of non-functional street lights add to the problem. This has been the case for the past three years. Several Complaints to the authorities were to no avail.



Kovur-Bharanthiputhur Service Road which runs along Perungalathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass on May 9, 2026; and (below) a non-functional street light.

*R.K. Ravichandran is the founder and president of IyyappanthangalB-*

*haranthiputhur Consumer Rights Protection Society*

## Road waits for restoration



▼ Vinayagam Road which connects Kamarajar Road in Saligramam and Kali Amman Kovil Street in Virugambakkam needs to be restored. A gas pipe was laid on this road but following the completion of the work, the road has not been restored. This has been the status for -close to a month. PHOTOS: VELANKANNI RAJ B

## You can be our volunteer writer



Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to [downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in](mailto:downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in). Letters must carry the contact number



# Free waste service for BWGs raises questions

Here are some of the posers. Has this move by Greater Chennai Corporation sounded the death knell of in situ composting? Are bulk waste generators being divested of their responsibility? Will this decision put waste management infrastructure under greater strain?



File photo of an awareness rally conducted by Greater Chennai Corporation and Urbaser Sumeet. PHOTO : B. VELANKANNI RAJ

**Quick Fact**  
A Bulk Waste Generator (BWG) is one who meets any one of the following criteria as per the SWM Rules, 2026  
**100 kg/day** - Waste generation  
**20,000 sq.m** - Built-up area  
**40,000 litres/day** - Water usage

LIFFY THOMAS

**W**ith Greater Chennai Corporation authorising private conservancy operators, Ramky and Urbaser Sumeet, to collect waste from bulk generators at no fee, has the city's push for in-situ composting taken a backseat?

The Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 that came into effect on April 1, 2026 requires all bulk waste generators to process wet waste in-situ or obtain an Extended Bulk Waste Generator Responsibility certificate stating that on-site processing is not feasible. Bulk waste generators are those who produce more than 100 kilos of waste a day or have a built-up area of 20,000 sq.m or consume 40,000 litres of water a day.

This should have ideally been an opportunity for municipal corporations and panchayats to push bulk waste generators such as large gated communities, sprawling IT parks and big commercial buildings to treat maximum amount of biodegradable waste at source or at least push them to find ways to create space

to start composting in a small way.

GCC authorised Ramky and Urbaser Sumeet to collect waste from bulk generators as it was receiving many complaints of illegal dumping of waste in public spaces by some vendors who collect waste. Some bulk waste generators have also been unable to find the right vendors to dispose of the waste.

Other vendors in this business say Chennai has inadequate infrastructure to process the collected waste. The many micro composting centres that once thrived have reduced in number.

Mahmood Sait, CEO, Urbaser Sumeet, says if a property does not have space then it is better that government takes up.

Urbaser Sumeet collects all kinds of waste including hazardous waste if a community does not have its own treatment centre, but insists people segregate and hand it over to them in a specific bin.

"Earlier every bulk waste generator had to pay a vendor to do this; now they are not being charged but must give the waste to authorised concessionaires and we are responsible for zones

IX to XV," says Sait. Ramky is in charge of Zones I to V.

Since the new changes came into effect, Urbaser Sumeet is getting 40% of waste from bulk generators.

"Some have refused to give us the waste as they want an order from GCC. We have a list of apartment and commercial buildings that are not handing it to our team and we are discussing this with GCC," says Sait.

Certain resident associations might be happy that they are saving money with the new system, but communities that have sustainable waste management practices hope the arrangement does not undo the good work they have done over the years.

Sumitha Iyer, waste segregation team, The Central Park South and committee lead, FOMRRA Swachh Bharat, says the new system is yet to pass muster among residents.

Central Park South in Sholinganallur, for instance, follows the practice of weighing the waste it generates before sending it out. Its organic waste vendor was selected after frequent checks of the composting site. It slaps a fine on residents who do

not hand over segregated waste.

"We have built trust over the years with the vendor by seeing how they do, but we are yet to get the same confidence from the new system," says Sumitha.

She has decided to wait till the end of the month before engaging with Urbaser Sumeet's ground staff. Questions that many environment-conscious residents like her have are: where is the waste being sent? Is the waste getting mixed? How much compost is generated? Can they go and see it?

Geo Damin, former member of Tamil Nadu Solid Waste Management and member of Poovulagin Nanbargal, says decentralised waste management system is the future.

He says, "With the new SWM Rules, GCC should have insisted on on-site composting. This would be cost-effective for the Corporation as it need not spend money on transportation and in finding sites to treat such waste."

Damin also thinks levying a user fee for solid waste management depending on the size of the building could be considered.

## Guide for bulk waste generators

**U**rbaser Sumeet has started distributing a service guide for all bulk waste generators (BWGs). The booklet offers guidelines for proper waste management, explaining what qualifies an entity as bulk waste generator and outlines bin standards, collection timings, grievance redressal and the vehicles used for waste collection. It also insists that its staff should not be paid for services.

To avail its services, a BWG must register on <https://gccservices.in/bulkwaste/register>. The BWG must procure wheeled, labelled and clean bins and move the bins to the main gate before the scheduled collection time.



# Sting operations with a difference

On World Bee Day, meet three residents of Chennai who have established a bond with bees in very different ways: from managing structured frame hives in urban backyards to nurturing colonies on city campuses, and allowing a wild hive to thrive undisturbed in a neem tree at home

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

## Removing bugs, raising bees

For Rajendran Tamilaras, an IT professional based near Tambaram, beekeeping exists alongside software work, family life and ecological advocacy: a parallel world sustained less by commerce than by fascination. Originally from Mullukurichi village near the foothills of Kolli Hills in Namakkal district, he traces his interest in bees back to childhood memories of accompanying his maternal uncle during honey collection from wild colonies formed on coconut trees. "I would stand below creating smoke while he climbed up to harvest honey," he recalls. Smoke, he explains, temporarily disrupts the bees' scent-based communication system, reducing their ability to signal danger to one another. "This way, both we and the bees stay safe."

Nearly a decade ago, that childhood curiosity gradually evolved into T R Bees and Apiary, a small-scale urban bee farm in Chennai. Operating from the Madambakkam, Rajendran now manages backyard bee colonies while balancing his full-time IT career. Supported closely by his wife, he sells bee colonies to households interested in setting up



hives at home and conducts awareness programmes on pollination, bee behaviour and colony maintenance. Initially, he says, the initiative began as an educational effort aimed at helping people understand how bees contribute to pollination and biodiversity. Over time, increasing public awareness transformed the nature of his work. "Earlier, people immediately called pest control services.

Now many contact us to rescue colonies instead of destroying them," he says. Much of his work in Chennai involves relocating giant hives from apartment buildings and commercial

spaces to safer environments near forested areas. He also trains residents in maintaining backyard hives, inspecting colony health and handling bees safely. Contrary to assumptions about urban spaces being hostile to pollinators, he believes Chennai's mixed vegetation offers bees a surprisingly stable food network throughout the year. "One house may have moringa trees, another ornamental flowers, another coconut or banana plants," he says. "So throughout the year, bees get different nectar sources."

He can be contacted at 99625 91218.

## 'Admissions' on campuses

K. Vasanthakumar moved to Chennai in 2001 after erratic rainfall disrupted farming at his village in Rajapalayam. In the city's dense neighbourhoods, he was quick to notice what others ignored: flowering drumstick trees spilling over compound walls and scattered open plots still capable of sustaining bees. "In those days, areas like Anna Nagar and Arumbakkam had plenty of flowering plants. I felt bees could survive even in a city like Chennai," he says. That instinct deepened in 2006, when he helped a resident in Medavakkam install a bee box that yielded nearly three kilograms of honey within a month. "I was very surprised that we got to eat honey, especially in a city," he recalls. The following year, additional colonies migrated naturally to the area and the yield rose further, convincing him to transport the rest of his bee boxes permanently from his native village to Chennai.

Today, from Kolathur, he runs Amudha Bee Farm, a modest but sustained urban beekeeping initia-

tive rooted in practices inherited from his grandfather. He installs bee colonies in residential compounds, the Guindy horticulture, the Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) campus in Madhavaram and shaded open spaces with sufficient flowering vegetation. In villages, he explains, colonies form easily near coconut groves and wells. In Chennai, however, survival depends on carefully identifying quieter pockets insulated from traffic, disturbance and excessive heat.

The process begins with a wooden bee box fitted with frames containing worker bees, broods and a queen bee. As the queen lays eggs and the colony expands, overcrowding is prevented by shifting the queen and a few bees into another box, allowing a fresh colony to emerge naturally. Honey extraction, he says, is done carefully using gloves, veils and controlled smoke so that neither the bees nor the honey are harmed. Alongside honey production, Vasanthakumar also prepares small batches of beeswax-based lip balms, face creams and pain balms. "Honey keeps the skin soft and protected, while beeswax locks in moisture naturally," he says, describing them as gentler alternatives to chemical-heavy skin care products.

He supplies bee boxes and live bee colonies on order, along with honey and beeswax-based products. His range of cosmetics includes a 25-gram face cream priced at ₹100 per box and lip balms priced at ₹100 per piece. Yet, despite growing awareness around pollinators, fear continues to influence public attitudes towards bees. "Many people are scared because bees sting. But bees are soft in nature unless they feel threatened," he says. He can be contacted at 99418 68926.



## Summer home stay

Every summer, residents of Nallappa Street in Chromepet begin looking towards a neem tree inside M. Sreedhar's compound that has, over the years, become an unlikely refuge for migrating wild bees. For nearly seven years, colonies have returned to the same branches, building large suspended hives that remain there for



months before dispersing once again.

Unlike conventional beekeepers who manage colonies through wooden frames and controlled extraction, Sreedhar practises a quieter form of stewardship. He does not harvest honey or interfere with the hive. Instead, he simply allows the bees to arrive, inhabit the tree and eventually leave on their own terms.

"For the past six years, every year the bees come, build a nest and stay there for around three to six months depending on the cli-

mate," he says. "The current nest would be the eighth one built here."

This year, however, the bees have been delayed. Sreedhar attributes the absence partly to excessive humidity and increased pesticide spraying in nearby areas. Yet he remains hopeful they will return once conditions improve.

According to him, the bees' repeated migration is closely tied to the environment his family has cultivated around the house. Over the years, they have planted near-

ly 30 native trees within the compound, creating a shaded corridor that supports birds, insects and pollinators alike.

"These are not ordinary bees," he says. "They require a healthy ecosystem. There should not be too much noise, disturbance or harsh sunlight." Far from provoking fear, the colonies have gradually become accepted within the neighbourhood. During one season, residents even switched off exterior lights at night after noticing bees becoming disoriented and dying from the heat.





A row of vehicles parked along Meenambakkam haltover on GST Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

## A bus stop that serves other vehicles

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

**A**t Meenambakkam stop on GST Road, towards Saint Thomas Mount, commuters can be seen waiting under the sky to board the buses. This is not because the haltover does not have a roof. In fact, there is a spacious shelter with good seating facility. However, the area along the elevated haltover is used as a parking lot.

Commuters have requested the Metropolitan Transport Corpora-

tion to ensure the stopping point premises are free of vehicles.

A. Akilan, a commuter, says, "Due to parking of vehicles, bus drivers halt on the road before and after the stopover area. The commuters hurry from the sheltered area to board the buses. When rushing to board buses, the two-wheeler riders drive, blocking the way for commuters. The women and the children are the worst affected."

D. Thendral Dinakaran, a commuter, says, "We have to hurry from the haltover area and signal

to halt. At times, drivers do not halt, unless there are commuters alighting at the haltover. When a row of buses approaches the haltover, the commuters must take on the role of runners.

This affects traffic on the stretch. The MTC should create a bus bay and deploy bay keepers."

Pedestrians are also affected and have to walk on the carriage-way amid traffic. An email from the MTC stated that the complaint has been noted and that necessary action will be taken to address it.

## Theatre workshop for children



Through games, movement, storytelling and team work, this theatre workshop creates a space for children to play, imagine, express and connect freely while building confidence, empathy, creativity and trust in themselves and others.

According to a press release, theatre and film actor-directors and trained clowns Aparna Gopi-

nath and Santhakumar will be conducting this workshop for children aged 7 to 11.

Venue: Shree Music Academy, 51, Nelson Manickam Road, Tiruvenkadapuram, Choolaimedu, Chennai - 600094

Dates: May 27 - June 6

Time: 9.00 am - 11.00 am

For registration, call 9080267665

## MSME training programmes

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute, a Department of MSME, is conducting a workshop on baking from May 19 to 22. According to a press release, the programme will focus on making cookies, pizzas, breads, and cakes from millets, wheat, and heirloom rice varieties.

### Preparation of DPR

The institute is also conducting

another workshop on "Detailed Project Report Preparation" from May 21 to 22. According to a press release, the session will focus on basics of entrepreneurship, market survey, industrial policy of the State, and MSME classification and registration.

Both the programmes will be held at the institute's premises on SIDCO Industrial Estate, EDII Institute Road, Guindy. Phone: 8668102600 / 87544 95254.

## An Anand in the making



A young chess talent from 'Namma Chennai', Jeshua J., has earned recognition in the Indian Book of Records and the Asia Book of Records for becoming the 'Youngest Arena FIDE' master.

A Grade 3 student of Velammal Bodhi Campus, Kolapakkam, has demonstrated exceptional dedication, discipline and talent in chess.

To achieve this milestone, Jeshua played more than 1,000 games on the official FIDE online platform and competed against several open-rated players from various categories and countries. Through his consistent performances, determination and passion for the game, he successfully secured the prestigious 'Arena FIDE Master' title. Jeshua has been undergoing training at T. Nagar Chess Academy under AL. Kasi (FI), the Academy's honorary secretary, and his daughter, Krithiga Kasi (WCM), issued a press release on behalf of the Academy.

His parents, Jebarson Paul and Shanthini, have consistently supported and encouraged his passion for chess from an early age.

## Session on making pickles

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on making pickles and pastes on May 21. Another workshop on making mushrooms will be held on May 22. Both the sessions will be held at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. For details, call 044 - 29530048.



**BUYING ANY CONDITION**  
▲ LED ▲ OLED ▲ CTvs  
▲ Music System ▲ Sound Bars  
▲ Genset ▲ Bureau  
▲ Laptops ▲ Computers  
▲ A/c's ▲ Stabilizers  
▲ Geyser ▲ Motor ▲ Fridges  
▲ Machineries ▲ W.Machines  
▲ Android Phones  
▲ Battery ▲ Invertors  
Old cars & Bikes for Best Price  
**Sweatha Electronics**  
93827 28672/93827 28677

**PROPOSED 2&3 BHK FLAT FOR SALE AT LAKSHMI STREET WEST MAMBALAM AND BALU STREET THIRUVANMIYUR**  
**MADHAV ASSOCIATES**  
**98410 51622**

**SOFA SERVICE ANY SOFA'S RECLINER SOFAS CUSHIONS REUPHOLSTERY**  
Reconditioning @ Very Moderate Charges  
**K.N.S.RAJAN SERVICES**  
**76671 33233**  
**93818 03956**

To advertise in  
**DOWNTOWN**  
Contact:  
**UDHAYAKUMAR**  
**81246 14787**

**STARTING TROUBLE OF UPS OR VEHICLE BATTERY? Immediate Doorstep Service & Emergency Road side Assistance by Experienced Technician. Minimum charge applicable**  
**98403 39844**  
**95661 43904**

**SEEMAN Tuitions and Tutorials**  
State board / Cbse Online / Off line  
9th, 10th, 11th, 12th  
Maths • Physics  
Chemistry  
Computer science  
Accountancy  
Business studies  
Economics  
History • Science  
Social science  
Enroll now, build excellence.  
Toppers are not born! They are trained!!  
**99628 73241**



# Tailored second innings for old clothes

E. Umapathy runs a tailoring shop at Spencers Plaza First Phase that specialises in mending old clothes



E. Umapathy at work.  
PHOTO: R. RAGU



During the pandemic, he had been down on his luck, being out of employment, and that adversity sowed in his mind the idea of independence

price increases from there only on the basis of the complexity of the alteration work. I undertake alteration work that most tailors baulk at. For example, when it comes to altering jeans pants, most tailors would undertake alteration that requires them to make those pants tighter, and reject work that requires jeans pants to be made looser. I accept both forms of work. Within a 10-kilometre radius, I offer door delivery if the payment for the alteration work comes up to ₹500. I deliver the clothes by a bike in the late evening hours."

Umapathy's regular expenditure includes paying for the education of two college-going children. Asked if he manages to meet his expenses without difficulty, he says, "I manage but with difficulty."

P. Goutham Chand, a regular customer at Chennai Stitcher, says Umapathy never says "no" to any clothes that are brought to him for alteration. Among the clothes that Goutham has got altered by Umapathy is an old coat. Goutham notes that among factors enhancing customer experience is the fast delivery ensured by Umapathy.

Umapathy can be contacted at 9884541415

R. RAGU

In a mall where shops woo visitors with spanking-new clothes stands a rank outlier, a shop that wears old clothes like a badge of honour. Chennai Stitcher, as this shop at the second floor of Spencers Plaza First Phase is called, is not about selling pre-loved clothes, but making those old clothes loved once again by the same owner.

A resident of Royapettah for nearly 20 years, E. Umapathy has positioned Chen-

nai Stitcher as a specialist in old cloth alteration work. The 47-year-old tailor has not sealed the seam on new clothes though; he readily stitches new clothes for people bringing that kind of work to him. But alteration of old clothes is his staple service, old clothes for women, men and children coming within its ambit.

Umapathy established this shop, which operates within a shop selling new apparel around a year ago. Those visiting the apparel showrooms in the mall learn about his services and bring their old clothes the next time they are at the mall.

In his previous avatars, Umapathy had been a master tailor for 10 years at an apparel major and worked in the Cable TV industry for seven years.

During the pandemic, he had been down on his luck, being out of employment, and that adversity sowed in his mind the idea of independence and relative certainty that can derive from being one's own boss.

Umapathy lists among his USPs reasonable pricing, wide repertoire and door delivery.

"My basic alteration price is ₹60 and the

## Student innovators to be honoured

Nominations are open for CavinKare-MMA ChinniKrishnan Innovation and Great Ideas Awards 2026

CavinKare, in association with the Madras Management Association (MMA), is inviting nominations for the 15<sup>th</sup> CavinKare-MMA ChinniKrishnan Innovation and Great Ideas Awards 2026. This

year's edition sees the reintroduction of the 'Great Ideas' category, revived with an expanded scope to include student innovators. The category will recognise 10 outstanding ideas, a significant scale-up from earlier editions where a single

winner was awarded, said a release. Interested institutions and individuals can apply for the awards by submitting their entries on or before June 22, 2026 at [www.ckinnovationawards.in](http://www.ckinnovationawards.in). Or call 9444700068 to register.

The awards feature two categories: Innovation Category: Open to startups and MSMEs with proven, market-ready products or services that demonstrate uniqueness, scalability, sustainability, and tangible benefits to people. Three winners in this category will receive a cash prize of ₹1,00,000, a citation and a trophy each. The 'Great Ideas Category' is open to individuals and institutions including entrepreneurs, researchers, academicians, and students this category recognises

original ideas with strong problem. Ten winners in this category will receive a cash prize of ₹10,000 each.

Applications under the Innovation Category are open to startups and small-scale enterprises with an annual turnover not exceeding ₹50 crore for FY 2024-25 / 2025-26, while the Great Ideas Category is open to individuals and institutions across India with no turnover criteria; applicants must be Indian citizens or have ideas originating from India, added the release.